

Future Tense

Pakistani President Pervez Musharraf's future hangs upon the outcome of his war with terror ("Musharraf's Last Stand", August 6). His days, though, seem numbered as he does not enjoy the kind of the American and Pakistani confidence he used to. VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *Dehradun*

No military dictator, in Pakistan's history, has ever relinquished power smoothly. One can always expect Musharraf to impose martial law if he does not get the approval of the political parties. K.R.P. GUPTA, *on e-mail*

Media Hallow

It does not take mere good writing skills to make a story the "world's greatest fairytale ever written" ("Hallow and Goodbye", August 6). Packaging and media hype is necessary too. The success of the Harry Potter series proves just that.

SANKALP KATHURIA, *Jaipur*

For Adults' Sake

The draft Broadcasting Bill proposes that adult content be broadcast late at night. This proposal, however, is likely to adversely impact the country's GDP since the adults won't be able to work properly during the day after watching television late at night ("Control Peak", August 6). MAHESH KUMAR, *Delhi*

Broad-Casting a Net

The apathy and ignorance of the Indian people is the reason why politicians get away with absurdities. And

this is where the media comes in. The media should inspire people to put an end to the dominance of our selfish politicians.

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

Although most of the stuff that one watches on television is quite crude, it does not give the Government a licence to try and rein in the channels. It would be better if the channels formed bodies of their own to control their content themselves.

PRANAB DESHPANDE, *on e-mail*

On a Wrong Track

There is hardly any need to host a Formula 1 race in the country. Most racing cars are fuel guzzlers and we are already sick of the pollution caused by the thousands of automobiles that ply on the roads ("NK's New Race", July 30). Moreover, hosting such an event will not spread the sports culture amongst the Indians.

P. SUNDER, *on e-mail*

HEALTHY PROGRESSION



In a materialistic world where political, economic, social and cultural conundrums predominate one's life, who wants to live till 100 ("How to Live Long and Well", July 30)?

A.S. RAJ, *on e-mail*

We had been quite concerned about our future considering the agonising experiences which several old people in one of your stories went through ("Home Alone", July 16). But now you are advising us on how to live till 100. Should we hope to die soon to save ourselves from such an ignominy, or should we keep fit and live long in the hope that we will be fortunate enough?

PRADEEP B. CHINAI, *Mumbai*

If the tips given in the story are followed religiously, one can easily keep the doctors miles away for years.

SARITA CHAUDHRY, *Delhi*

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday-Friday: 10am-6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com

30

Years Ago in India Today

AUGUST 16-31, 1977



A Dangerous Drift

The advent of the Janata Government at the Centre and in a majority of the states has succeeded in resurrecting the controversial language issue nearly a decade after the last *Angrezi Hatao* agitations. The real conflict, however, is not between Hindi and English but between Hindi and other languages.

English is sought to be continued only as a buffer against Morarji Desai Hindi's onslaught on the other languages. Hindi is feared for a more fundamental reason. It is seen by the non-Hindi speaking regions (especially the south) as the spearhead of a movement to impose the ethos of the backward Hindi belt on the entire country. The conflict is between two ways of life—of the economically and educationally backward but populous Hindi midland, which fancies itself as the heart and soul of India, and the relatively advanced coastlanders who have a different ethos.

—Mohan Ram